The Payson Morning Scroll

Made Exclusively for the Mogollon's Hearth Guests

"All the news worth knowing before the mead hall opens."

The Greybeards of High Hrothgar — Publisher & Proprietor

Payson, Arizona · Middas, the 21st of Frostfall (Wednesday, October 21, 2026) ·
Morning Edition — Vol. 2610, No. 21 · Price: One Septim



Gandy endures the storm under the eaves while Maevy bats at the raindrops.

Skies o'er the Hold

64° / 57°

Strong Storms

Sunrise 6:36 AM · Sunset 5:43 PM

Tomorrow — Strong storms, 63/49

The Moon's Reckoning



Yesterday *Tonight* *Tomorrow*

Waxing Gibbous

waxing toward the full moon

21st of Frostfall = October 21

Months run one-for-one all year

Sundas=Sun … Loredas=Sat

Around the Holds · The Week Ahead

Storms Over the Rim, Games Under the Lights



Payson, Ariz.



Ball games in Payson, painters in Sedona, and a treat trail in Show Low — all under a stormy Rim sky.

Hail, guest of the Hearth, and good Middas morning — the rain is drumming on the lodge roof, the pines are dripping, and a flood watch rides over Rim Country until late Thursday night, so travel with care today. Payson still plays tonight, with JV football in the late afternoon and varsity boys soccer under the lights, Sedona's plein air painters work into the evening, and Show Low opens its Trick or Treat Trail. Later this week come awards night in Sedona, Noley's Kids Club in Payson, and a Saturday stacked with the Monster Mash, an air fest, and a costume 5K — fill your mug, watch the washes, and plan hearty.

Happening in the Holds Today

- **Payson**

  — **JV Football — River Valley vs. Payson**, 4:45 to 7:15 p.m. at the Payson High School football field, 301 S. McLane Rd. Payson's junior varsity hosts River Valley in a late-afternoon home game, in the middle of the school's Cancer Awareness Week. It is an easy, neighborly outing for guests who want real small-town spirit. With strong storms forecast all day, check the school calendar before you head out in case the weather moves the game.

  — **Varsity Boys Soccer — Northland Prep at Payson**, 7:00 to 9:00 p.m. at Payson High School, 301 S. McLane Rd. The Longhorn boys host Northland Prep under the lights in regular-season play, and a home crowd always makes these evening matches lively. Come cheer the home side and enjoy a classic night at the field. Storms are in the forecast, so confirm the match is still on before you set out.

- **Sedona**

  — **Sedona Plein Air Festival — Paint Out at a Private Residence**, 4:00 to 7:00 p.m. at a private Sedona residence, address given to ticket holders; $60 per guest. In the 22nd Annual Sedona Plein Air Festival, running October 16–24 at the Sedona Arts Center, festival artists paint outdoors from 4:00 to 6:00 p.m. amid sweeping red-rock views. At 6:30 p.m. come awards and an exclusive sale of the works just created, with wine, beer, and Southwest barbecue as the sun sets. Tickets are limited, so reserve ahead if you go.

- **Show Low**

  — **Trick or Treat Trail**, today, Wednesday, October 21, in Show Low — the City's live feed announces the trail for today, with the start time and place on the flyer posted there. It is a family Halloween outing made for costumes, candy, and an easy walk, and children will love marching it in their finest spooky dress. Check the City feed for the flyer details before you go, bring a bag for treats and a light for the walk back, and mind the stormy weather.

- **Prescott**

  — **Long-Term Water Management Plan Community Meeting**, 1:00 to 3:00 p.m. at the Prescott Public Library. City staff present Prescott's long-term water plan — water supplies, current and future needs, and ways to save and use water wisely — in a 45-minute talk, followed by stations where residents can speak with City representatives. A short survey and water-saving resources are on hand, and the survey can also be taken by folks who cannot attend. A worthy stop for anyone who cares how a mountain town minds its water.

The Days Ahead

- **Thu, Oct. 22**

  — **Sedona — Lights On Afterschool Paint-Out**, 3:00 to 5:00 p.m. at West Sedona Elementary, free. Part of the Sedona Plein Air Festival week, this paint-out is held with the Lights On Afterschool program, and festival artists paint on site while families and visitors watch the work take shape outdoors. It is a relaxed, kid-friendly way to see plein air painting up close and ask how a painter catches red-rock light.

  — **Payson — Monthly Meeting**, 6:00 to 7:00 p.m. at the American Legion, 709 E. Hwy. 260, Payson. Listed as a monthly meeting to discuss runs and events, this is a neighborly evening stop for folks who follow local rides and gatherings. Arrive a little early if you want to meet people before the meeting starts.

- **Fri, Oct. 23**

  — **Payson — Noley's Kids Club**, 1:00 to 2:30 p.m. at Noley's, 103 E. State Highway 260, Payson. Michelle Guerrero reads her book The Christmas Witch, and there will be crafts, free books, and a giveaway, thanks to sponsor Time Out, Inc. A sweet, easy afternoon for young guests and their grown-ups, right in the heart of town.

  — **Sedona — Plein Air Festival Awards Night**, 5:00 to 7:00 p.m. at the Sedona Arts Center, 15 Art Barn Road. After a week of artists painting the red rocks outdoors, the festival gathers for its awards reception. It is the best night to see the week's strongest work in one room, meet the painters, and hear which canvases the judges chose, on the night before the final sale.

  — **Payson — Truckload Meat Sale**, Friday 10:00 a.m. to 7:00 p.m. and Saturday 9:00 a.m. to 7:00 p.m. in the Tractor Supply parking lot, 510 SR-260, Payson. The listing advertises 20 ribeyes for $50, family packs of beef, chicken, seafood, and pork, and discounts for first responders, military, and seniors on some items. Stock the Hearth's cold box while the truck is in town, while stock lasts.

- **Sat, Oct. 24**

  — **Payson — Monster Mash**, 4:00 to 9:30 p.m. at Green Valley Park. Payson's big Halloween evening returns, with costumes, crowds, and a fall night in the park. Bring chairs and blankets for the Halloween movie, The Nightmare Before Christmas, and enjoy the fun as Valley Dwellers trade the lowland heat for Rim Country air.

  — **Prescott — Regional Airport AirFest**, 11:00 a.m. to 5:00 p.m. at Prescott Regional Airport, 6110 Wilkinson Dr, free. The airport's air fest brings aircraft displays, military displays, food trucks, and hands-on touch-a-truck fun from Prescott Fire and Copperstate Ambulance. A free, family-friendly day for anyone who loves wings and wheels.

— **Prescott — Costumes for Kids 5K and Halloween Fest**, sign-in 9:00 a.m., 5K at 10:00 a.m., at Courthouse Square, 120 S. Cortez St. Yavapai CASA for Kids Foundation's costumed run winds through historic downtown, with a 1-mile fun run, music, game booths, free snacks, and prizes for the best costumes. Kids under 16 run free, and costumes are welcome but not required.
— **Sedona — Fall Arts and Crafts Show**, 9:00 a.m. to 3:00 p.m. at the Sedona Heritage Museum, 735 Jordan Road, free to attend. Dozens of local makers offer hand-crafted jewelry, home goods, gifts, and clothing, with food vendors on the grounds, and the museum itself is open and free for the day. Pair it with the Plein Air Festival's closing paint-out and final art sale at the Sedona Arts Center for a full art day.

- **Mon, Oct. 26**

  — **Sedona — "Sedona Plein Air at 22" Exhibition Opens**, October 26 through November 22 at the Sedona Arts Center, 15 Art Barn Road, open daily noon to 5:00 p.m. This follow-on exhibition gathers paintings made on location during the 22nd Annual Sedona Plein Air Festival, inspired by Sedona and the Verde Valley. It is a quieter, gallery way to see the festival's best work after the outdoor week ends.

Quests of the Hearth

Quests awaiting:



The shield, the torches, and the doors — the Hearth's workshop quests await.

- ☐ **Build the Mogollon's Hearth shield** — Overdue — was due Oct. 17. Finalize the size, cut and engrave the layered plywood, mount the 3D-printed troll relief, and finish with spar urethane.
- ☐ **Mount the shield by the front door** — Due Oct. 24. Hang it on a French cleat beside the front door, placed for best sight from the walkway.
- ☐ **Finish & install the torches** — Overdue — was due Oct. 10. Paint, seal for sun, wire the sockets with the breaker off, mount both torches, and test at dusk.
- ☐ **Print the torch sconces** — Overdue — was due Oct. 3. Print two torches plus the socket test piece and test-fit the bulb and socket.
- ☐ **Design & prep the torch sconces** — Overdue — was due Sept. 26. Measure the bulb and socket, scale the sconce model, check the door-light wiring, and slice in PETG.
- ☐ **Doors — Mogollon Hearth** — Due Oct. 24. The front and side door work for the guest house.

Due Saturday, Oct. 24: mount the shield by the front door, and the doors quest comes due the same day — the workshop will be busy, by the Nine!

Merchant of the Hold

Early Bird Cafe · *Pine*



The Early Bird Cafe in Pine — big breakfasts under the ponderosa pines.

A small, family-run cafe right on Highway 87 in Pine, under the ponderosa pines below the Rim, serving hearty country breakfast and lunch all day — as if a kindly spell kept the griddle hot from dawn to early afternoon. Portions are famously huge, there are daily specials, a dog-friendly patio, and gluten-free choices, and no reservations are taken. The signature thing to try is the Big Bird Breakfast, with the biscuits and gravy close behind — and do not pass the giant cinnamon rolls, kin in spirit to the sweet roll every traveler dreams of.

> *"Biscuits were perfect, just fluffy not dense, and the peppery gravy matched perfect."* — TripAdvisor review

3618 AZ-87, Pine, AZ 85544. Hours: Mon. 6:30 a.m.–1:00 p.m., Wed.–Sun. 6:30 a.m.–2:00 p.m., closed Tuesdays. Phone: (928) 476-4092. Price range: $, most meals $10–$20. Good to know: breakfast is served all day, no reservations are taken, so arrive near opening on busy weekends — and one order often feeds two.

Why the Hearth sends you: Because a real Rim Country breakfast — big plates, a small-town welcome, and fuel for a day on the trails — is worth the pretty drive up AZ-87, and this cafe pours it on with both hands. Great praise is great, and the Early Bird has earned every word!

Tales from the Treeline

The Puddle Mirror Fair



The Puddle Mirror Fair — admission one dry sock, and nobody could pay.

The storms rolled over the Rim all Middas morning, and by noon the Hearth clearing was a shining quilt of rain puddles. Flurry (a young ice-breathing dragon) had an idea, as Flurry does: one careful, frosty breath across each puddle, and every puddle turned into a perfect little mirror.

Henny (the Hearth's chicken) found hers first and admired herself for a full minute, turning this way and that like a queen at court. Earl (an elk) bent to inspect his reflection with great dignity, and a raindrop off his antler cracked his mirror into a hundred Earls, which he declared an improvement.

Then Jethro (the Mogollon Monster) tried to step daintily from mirror to mirror, as Mabel (a wood elf) had warned him not to. He landed sitting down in the one puddle Flurry had missed, soaked to the shag, grinning like the sun. Mabel sighed, handed him a towel, and declared the Puddle Mirror Fair open — admission one dry sock, which nobody in the clearing could pay.

Printed with pride in Payson, in the shadow of the Rim · Set in hot metal by Dude, Bard of the Morning Scroll · May your Middas be free of giants, Clay.

Ask the Hearth ✉

…or write to us straight: mogollonshearth@gmail.com